

Madeline Navarro

Rice University
Dept. of Electrical and Computer Engineering
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Research Interests

Signal processing; Optimization; Trustworthy and principled machine learning; Graphs and network science

Education

- Rice University**, Houston, TX, United States August 2020 – present
Ph.D. in Electrical Engineering
Advisor: Santiago Segarra
Thesis: “Learning graphs from data”
- Rice University**, Houston, TX, United States August 2020 – April 2023
M.Sc. in Electrical Engineering
Advisor: Santiago Segarra
Thesis: “Inference of multiple sparse networks in the presence of hidden nodes”
- Old Dominion University**, Norfolk, VA, United States January 2018 – May 2020
B.Sc. in Electrical Engineering, Minor in Computer Engineering
- Tidewater Community College**, Virginia Beach, VA, United States August 2012 – December 2017
A.S. in Electrical Engineering, *summa cum laude*

Publications

Book Chapters

- [B1] **Madeline Navarro**, Andrei Buciulea, Santiago Segarra, and Antonio G. Marques, “Higher-order graph signal processing”, *Handbook of Statistics*, 2026.

Peer-reviewed Journal Papers

- [J1] Lisa R. O’Bryan, **Madeline Navarro**, Juan Segundo Hevia, and Santiago Segarra, “ML-SPEAK: A theory-guided machine learning method for studying and predicting conversational turn-taking patterns”, *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology*, 2025.
- [J2] **Madeline Navarro**, Samuel Rey, Andrei Buciulea, Antonio G. Marques, and Santiago Segarra, “Joint network topology inference in the presence of hidden nodes”, *IEEE Transactions on Signal Processing*, vol. 72, pp. 2710–2725, 2024.
- [J3] **Madeline Navarro** and Santiago Segarra, “Joint network topology inference via a shared graphon model”, *IEEE Transactions on Signal Processing*, vol. 70, pp. 5549–5563, 2022.
- [J4] **Madeline Navarro**, Yuhao Wang, Antonio G. Marques, Caroline Uhler, and Santiago Segarra, “Joint inference of multiple graphs from matrix polynomials”, *Journal of Machine Learning Research*, vol. 23, no. 76, pp. 1–35, 2022.

Peer-reviewed Conference Papers

- [C1] **Madeline Navarro**, Lisa R. O’Bryan, and Santiago Segarra, “Learning time-varying turn-taking behavior in group conversations”, *arXiv preprint arXiv:2510.18649*, 2025. [Accepted at ICASSP 2026]
- [C2] Rostyslav Olshevskiy, **Madeline Navarro**, and Santiago Segarra, “Adaptive graph coarsening for efficient GNN training”, *arXiv preprint arXiv:2509.25706*, 2025. [Accepted at ICASSP 2026]
- [C3] Bishwadeep Das, **Madeline Navarro**, Santiago Segarra, and Elvin Isufi, “Bayesian filtering on graphs”, in *IEEE International Conference on Acoustics, Speech and Signal Processing (ICASSP)*, IEEE, 2025. [ICASSP 2025 Best Paper Award]
- [C4] **Madeline Navarro**, Sergio Rozada, Antonio G. Marques, and Santiago Segarra, “Low-rank tensors for multi-dimensional Markov models”, in *IEEE International Conference on Acoustics, Speech and Signal Processing (ICASSP)*, IEEE, 2025.
- [C5] Andrei Buciulea, **Madeline Navarro**, Samuel Rey, Santiago Segarra, and Antonio G. Marques, “Online network inference from graph-stationary signals with hidden nodes”, in *IEEE International Conference on Acoustics, Speech and Signal Processing (ICASSP)*, IEEE, 2025.
- [C6] Andrea Cavallo, **Madeline Navarro**, Santiago Segarra, and Elvin Isufi, “Fair coVariance neural networks”, in *IEEE International Conference on Acoustics, Speech and Signal Processing (ICASSP)*, IEEE, 2025.

- [C7] Samuel Rey, **Madeline Navarro**, Victor Tenorio, Antonio G. Marques, and Santiago Segarra, “Redesigning graph filter-based GNNs to relax the homophily assumption”, in *IEEE International Conference on Acoustics, Speech and Signal Processing (ICASSP)*, IEEE, 2025.
- [C8] Victor M. Tenorio, **Madeline Navarro**, Samuel Rey, Santiago Segarra, and Antonio G. Marques, “Structure-guided input graph for GNNs facing heterophily”, in *Asilomar Conference on Signals, Systems, and Computers*, IEEE, 2024.
- [C9] **Madeline Navarro**, Samuel Rey, Andrei Buciualea, Antonio G. Marques, and Santiago Segarra, “Fair GLASSO: Estimating fair graphical models with unbiased statistical behavior”, *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)*, 2024.
- [C10] **Madeline Navarro**, Samuel Rey, Andrei Buciualea, Antonio G. Marques, and Santiago Segarra, “Mitigating subpopulation bias for fair network topology inference”, in *European Signal Processing Conference (EUSIPCO)*, IEEE, 2024.
- [C11] **Madeline Navarro** and Santiago Segarra, “SC-MAD: Mixtures of higher-order networks for data augmentation”, in *IEEE International Conference on Acoustics, Speech and Signal Processing (ICASSP)*, pp. 13446–13450, IEEE, 2024.
- [C12] **Madeline Navarro**, Camille Little, Genevera I. Allen, and Santiago Segarra, “Data augmentation via subgroup mixup for improving fairness”, in *IEEE International Conference on Acoustics, Speech and Signal Processing (ICASSP)*, pp. 7350–7354, IEEE, 2024.
- [C13] Victor M. Tenorio, **Madeline Navarro**, Santiago Segarra, and Antonio G. Marques, “Recovering missing node features with local structure-based embeddings”, in *IEEE International Conference on Acoustics, Speech and Signal Processing (ICASSP)*, pp. 9931–9935, IEEE, 2024.
- [C14] **Madeline Navarro** and Santiago Segarra, “GraphMAD: Graph mixup for data augmentation using data-driven convex clustering”, in *IEEE International Conference on Acoustics, Speech and Signal Processing (ICASSP)*, pp. 1–5, IEEE, 2023.
- [C15] Samuel Rey, **Madeline Navarro**, Andrei Buciualea, Santiago Segarra, and Antonio G. Marques, “Joint graph learning from Gaussian observations in the presence of hidden nodes”, in *Asilomar Conference on Signals, Systems, and Computers*, pp. 53–57, IEEE, 2022.
- [C16] **Madeline Navarro** and Santiago Segarra, “Graphon-aided joint estimation of multiple graphs”, in *IEEE International Conference on Acoustics, Speech and Signal Processing (ICASSP)*, pp. 5458–5462, IEEE, 2022.
- [C17] Samuel Rey, Andrei Buciualea, **Madeline Navarro**, Santiago Segarra, and Antonio G. Marques, “Joint inference of multiple graphs with hidden variables from stationary graph signals”, in *IEEE International Conference on Acoustics, Speech and Signal Processing (ICASSP)*, pp. 5817–5821, IEEE, 2022.
- [C18] T. Mitchell Roddenberry, **Madeline Navarro**, and Santiago Segarra, “Network topology inference with graphon spectral penalties”, in *IEEE International Conference on Acoustics, Speech and Signal Processing (ICASSP)*, pp. 5390–5394, IEEE, 2021.

Preprints

- [P1] **Madeline Navarro**, Andrei Buciualea, Santiago Segarra, and Antonio G. Marques, “Stationarity and spectral characterization of random signals on simplicial complexes”, *arXiv preprint arXiv:2602.03055*, 2026.
- [P2] **Madeline Navarro**, Andrei Buciualea, Samuel Rey, Antonio G. Marques, and Santiago Segarra, “Estimating fair graphs from graph-stationary data”, *arXiv preprint arXiv:2510.07536*, 2025.
- [P3] Ali Azizpour, **Madeline Navarro**, and Santiago Segarra, “Adaptive node feature selection for graph neural networks”, *arXiv preprint arXiv:2510.03096*, 2025.
- [P4] Victor M. Tenorio, **Madeline Navarro**, Samuel Rey, Santiago Segarra, and Antonio G. Marques, “Adapting to heterophilic graph data with structure-guided neighbor discovery”, *arXiv preprint arXiv:2506.08871*, 2025.
- [P5] Camille Little, **Madeline Navarro**, Santiago Segarra, and Genevera I. Allen, “Fair feature importance scores via feature occlusion and permutation”, *ICLR 2025 Workshop Advances in Financial AI*, 2025.
- [P6] **Madeline Navarro**, Genevera I. Allen, and Michael Weylandt, “Network clustering for latent state and changepoint detection”, *arXiv preprint arXiv:2111.01273*, 2021.

Invited Talks

Principled and Interpretable Machine Learning via Signal Processing and Statistics <i>University of Delaware</i>	4 March 2026
Reducing GNN Complexity via Adaptive Learning <i>Universidad Rey Juan Carlos</i>	6 October 2025
Estimating Fair Graphs with Unbiased Connections <i>University of Pennsylvania</i>	22 April 2025
<i>Massachusetts Institute of Technology</i>	28 March 2025
<i>Carnegie Mellon University</i>	3 March 2025
<i>Jr. MINDS Seminar at Johns Hopkins University</i>	24 February 2025

Fair GLASSO: Estimating Fair Graphical Models with Unbiased Statistical Behavior <i>Prof. Genevera Allen Group Meeting at Columbia University</i> <i>SIAM Conference on Mathematics of Data Science (MDS24)</i>	20 November 2024 24 October 2024
MAD Overview: Mixup for Augmenting Data in Myriad Scenarios <i>Delft University of Technology</i> <i>Universidad Rey Juan Carlos</i>	11 July 2024 15 January 2024
Fair Network Topology Inference with Unbiased Connections <i>University of Virginia</i>	21 February 2025
Mitigating Subpopulation Bias for Fair Network Topology Inference <i>Graph Signal Processing Workshop 2024</i>	24 June 2024
Joint Network Topology Inference <i>Universidad Rey Juan Carlos</i>	17 January 2024
GraphMAD: Graph Mixup for Data Augmentation using Data-Driven Convex Clustering <i>Graph Signal Processing Workshop 2023</i>	13 June 2023

Awards

- ICASSP 2025 Best Paper Award for “Bayesian Filtering on Graphs”

Service

- Reviewer for machine learning venues: Journal of Machine Learning Research (JMLR), Neural Processing Letters, Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)
- Reviewer for journals: IEEE Transactions on Signal Processing (TSP), IEEE Signal Processing Letters (SPL), IEEE Transactions on Signal and Information Processing over Networks (TSIPN), Signal Processing (SIGPRO), IEEE Open Journal of Signal Processing (OJSP)
- Reviewer for conferences: IEEE International Symposium in Information Theory (ISIT), IEEE International Conference on Acoustics, Speech, and Signal Processing (ICASSP), IEEE International Workshop on Computational Advances in Multi-Sensor Adaptive Processing (CAMSAP)

Teaching Experience

Department of Electrical and Computer Engineering, Rice University <i>Teaching Assistant</i>	Houston, TX
• ELEC 573: Network Science and Analytics, <i>Graduate Level</i>	Fall 2024
• ELEC 242: Signals, Systems, & Transforms, <i>Undergraduate Level</i>	Spring 2024
• ELEC 478/578: Introduction to Machine Learning, <i>Undergraduate/Graduate Level</i>	Fall 2023
• ELEC 242: Signals, Systems, & Transforms, <i>Undergraduate Level</i>	Spring 2023
• ELEC 573: Network Science and Analytics, <i>Graduate Level</i>	Fall 2022
• ELEC 242: Signals, Systems, & Transforms, <i>Undergraduate Level</i>	Spring 2022
• ELEC 573: Network Science and Analytics, <i>Graduate Level</i>	Fall 2021
Tidewater Community College <i>Math Tutor</i>	Virginia Beach, VA August 2016 – August 2019

Professional Memberships

Sigma Xi, The Scientific Research Honor Society	Full Member
IEEE Membership	Student Member
IEEE Signal Processing Society (SPS) Membership	Student Member
IEEE Young Professionals	Student Member

Industry Experience

NAVSEA

Student Trainee

Virginia Beach, VA
June 2019 – September 2019

- Assisted RF engineering team with implementing transmitters and receivers for Naval training purposes
- Helped RF engineers develop decoding equipment to replace obsolete systems

INIT

APC Intern

Chesapeake, VA
October 2018 – April 2019

- Developed SQL queries for processing automatic passenger counting data from train station servers
- Inspected and programmed sensory hardware components before implementation
- Created dashboard visualizations of query data via Elasticsearch, Logstash, and Kibana
- Consulted on purchasing lidar equipment for station detection during train operation